

DISTRICT SPECIAL · CHUSEOK D-9

Only Eulji-ro's drink talk grew

01 Drink mentions on social media: six districts, 20 months

Seongsu -21%, Dosan -33%, Sindang -31%, Eulji-ro +18%

02 Chuseok D-9: six days left

To the last delivery before the break — the final order calendar

03 Orders pile onto the last delivery day before the break

Sewang shipments — week before 164, holiday week 45, week after 111

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+18%

Eulji-ro drink mentions
adjusted change (Jan–Aug)

41%

Eulji-ro's share of drink
mentions, six districts

–33%

Dosan · Apgujeong Rodeo
steepest fall

Editor's note — A common error is to read two months and call it a rise. We did, last month. **Re-measured over 20 months, the answer was the opposite.** This issue lays out all 20.



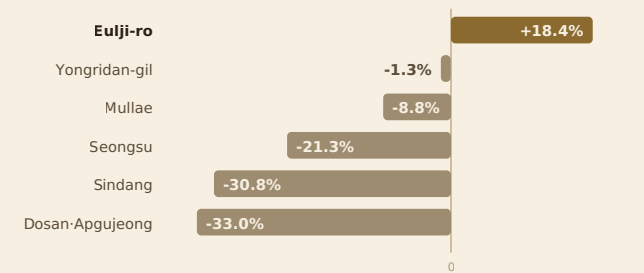
Six districts, 20 months laid out

Seongsu, Eulji-ro, Dosan, Sindang, Yongridan-gil, Mullae. For the six Seoul districts people name for drinking, we counted how often each was **mentioned together with alcohol** on Instagram, from January 2025. **Only one grew.**

Drink talk grew in one place only

Monthly counts of each district name posted with alcohol on Instagram, adjusted by ‘beer’ mentions (−4.5%).

JAN-AUG CHANGE · ADJUSTED BY BEER MENTIONS (%)



Five of the six fell. Only Eulji-ro rose, and it leads **on raw count** too: 8,686 mentions in Jan–Aug, nearly double Seongsu’s 4,490.

District · share of mentions	2025	2026
Eulji-ro	31.7%	41.0%
Seongsu-dong · Seongsu Stn.	24.6%	21.2%
Dosan · Apgujeong Rodeo	14.7%	10.7%
Yongridan-gil · Sinyongsan	9.7%	10.5%
Sindang · Yaksu	10.9%	8.3%
Mullae	8.4%	8.4%

IN ONE LINE

Four in ten drink mentions across the six districts are about **Eulji-ro** (six = 100). In one year, 9.3pp moved to one place.

Source: Sometrend Instagram monthly, district + alcohol, 2025.1–2026.8, Sep excluded. Rounded.

Why Eulji-ro

We pulled the top 100 words that appear when Eulji-ro is named alongside drinking. The answer was not ‘hip’ alone.

ALLEYS

Hipjiro 677

Jongno 458

Chungmuro 228

Alley 155

OUTDOOR SEATS

Terrace 231

Show 220

Live 218

Rooftop 172

OLD-SHOP DISHES

Broth 310

Whelk 245

Squid 189

Chicken 186

The three clusters point one way: **alleys + outdoor seats + old-shop dishes**. That is exactly the yajang condition (street-front, outdoor seating) we covered last issue. Eulji-ro always had its beer alleys and street benches, and of the six districts we measured this year, only the one with that axis grew.

The list also carries **company dinner 204** and **new opening 179** — a sign that group bookings and new-venue enquiries are still live here. Frequency alone does not settle scale.

This is not a call to move district. Eulji-ro’s axis — alleys, outdoor seats, broth dishes — can be built in Seongsu or in Gangnam too. What this issue points to is not an address but an **axis**.

FOR OPERATORS

① Decide first whether your axis is ‘polished’ or ‘alley’ — the one growing is the alley. ② Outdoor seats + beer and soju + a broth dish is the surest demand; premium sits on top. ③ The week after the break (from 9/28) comes back above normal — do not leave that order empty.

Source: Sometrend Instagram top-100 associated keywords (Eulji-ro, 2026.7.1–9.11)

Chuseok D-9: six days left

Chuseok falls on Friday 25 September; the break runs four days, Thursday the 24th to Sunday the 27th. The last delivery before it is **Wednesday 23 September — six trading days from the day this report goes out.**

Date	What to do
Wed 9/16 · today	Fix holiday volumes · split out chilled items
Thu 9/17–Fri 9/18	Recommended first order cutoff
Sat 9/19–Sun 9/20	Last weekend before the break · measure turnover
Mon 9/21	Final order cutoff · split delivery ①
Tue 9/22	Split delivery ②
Wed 9/23	Last delivery before the break
9/24–9/27	Distribution closed · on-call cover
Mon 9/28	Deliveries resume · back to normal

TAKE IT IN TWO LOADS

What changes is not the items but the **timing**. It piles up before the break, halves in the holiday week, and returns to normal the week after. **Do not take it all on 9/23 — split it across 9/21–23, and book the 9/28 restart separately.** Draft kegs in particular stop turning over the four closed days.

Sewang Market Report skips the Chuseok week (Sep 23) and returns Wednesday Sep 30. Delivery dates around the October Foundation Day and Hangul Day holidays will be confirmed individually by your sales rep.



Orders are only deferred

Account orders: week before 164 • holiday week 45. **And the week after, 111.**

Orders pile onto the last delivery day

Our own data this time, not someone else’s. We laid out, day by day, what Sewang accounts actually ordered (shipments) — restaurants and bars only, normal week = 100.

Last year’s Chuseok ran into two October holidays and stopped deliveries for **ten days**. This year it is **four**. So we set it beside **this year’s Seollal in February**, a five-day stop.

Week	Seollal · 5 days	Last Chuseok · 10 days
2 weeks before	118	—
Week before	164	169
Holiday week	45	43
Week after	111	86
2–3 weeks after	105–110	86–90

ORDERS ARE ONLY DEFERRED

At Seollal the week after came **straight back to 111**. The ten-day Chuseok held three weeks at 86–90. **Leave the week-after order empty and there is nothing to meet it.**

The peak day is fixed too. Seollal’s week-before orders by weekday (same weekday, normal = 100): **Mon 109 · Tue 149 · Wed 220 · Thu 170 · Fri 167** — the multiple peaks Wednesday, but **absolute volume peaks Friday, the last delivery day before the break**. This year that day is **Wed 9/23** alone: five days of Seollal orders must land in **9/21–23**.

Source: Sewang shipments (restaurants & bars), 2025.9–12 · 2026.1–3. Index vs. a normal week.

Three questions: axis • order • after

Q1 YOUR AXIS

What grew this year is not ‘polished’ but ‘alley’ — outdoor seats, broth dishes, beer and soju. Which side is your menu on?

Q2 DID YOU SPLIT THE ORDER

The week before the break runs at 164 of normal, the holiday week at 45. Take it all on the last delivery day and the store room bursts. Did you split it across 9/21, 22 and 23?

Q3 THE WEEK AFTER

A four-day break defers demand rather than removing it. Measured, the week after ran at 111 of normal. Have you left 9/28–10/2 empty?

Item	9/16–9/23	9/28–Oct
Beer • soju	Increase	Increase
Traditional • fruit liquor	Increase	Hold
Draft beer kegs	Split around break	Increase
Whisky • spirits	Hold	Hold
Sake • cheongju	Hold	Increase
Broth-dish stock	Hold	Increase

Your sales rep will propose a mix sized to your venue and district.

Yajang opened as forecast

Last issue we said the yajang season opens **from the second week of September**. Mentions rose from the August low of 703 to **1,205 in the first week of September, up 71%** — as forecast. The last two weeks are incomplete, so the beer-adjusted share returns next issue. The Golden Zone runs **to the last week of October**: six weeks.

SEOUL BRINGS OUTDOOR SEATING INTO THE RULEBOOK

On 31 August Seoul City gave public notice of a draft **Guideline on Road Occupancy for Outdoor Dining** — the first rules for pavement tables. Kerbed streets: keep **2 m of walking width** (min. 1.5 m); alleys: **4 m of passage**; trade inside the painted line; clear at close. 15 districts applied; **5 pilots chosen mid-September → open in October**, all 25 by 2028. Candidates: Jongno Songhae-gil, **Jung-gu Sindang-dong**, Dongdaemun Cheongnyangni — the Sindang at -31% in this issue.

IF YOU HAVE NO OUTDOOR SEATING

① **Sell the combination, not the seat.** The Golden Zone sells beer/soju + hot soup, outdoor tables or not — raise draft turnover and soup dishes through October. ② **Open the front.** On 15–23°C evenings, folding doors and window seats do half the job of an outdoor table. ③ **If your district is a pilot, apply.** Permits go by district, not shop; check the announcement and review volume and turnover with your sales rep.

Source: Sometrend Instagram weekly 2026.6.22–9.11 / Seoul City public notice 2026.8.31 / Herald Economy, Yonhap, Asia Economy 9.6–9.9

NEXT ISSUE

Next week (9/23) we skip for the Chuseok break. Next issue Wed 9/30 — post-holiday restart checklist and the five pilot districts.

A partner that grows alongside you

From Chuseok volumes to the restart in the first week back and urgent stock during the break, your sales rep will advise you to suit your venue. Founded in 1978, Sewang Trading has served Seoul and Gyeonggi as a full-line liquor wholesaler for nearly half a century.

Lee Han-woo VP	010-5210-5449
Sales, overall	
Lim Chang-soo Exec. Dir.	010-3742-3054
Gangnam Yeoksam · Nonhyeon · Sinsa · Cheongdam / Seongdong · Gwangjin	
Park Jung-eon Exec. Dir.	010-3286-9489
Gangnam Daechi · Samseong / Seocho · Bangbae / Gwanak · Dongjak	
Son Seung-il Man. Dir.	010-7539-3535
Franchise accounts	
Lee Won-cheol Director	010-3354-2101
Gangbuk · Jongno · Jung-gu / Dongdaemun · Jungnang · Nowon · Dobong	
Chae Hyun-yong Director	010-8889-3057
Hotels · wine	
Kim Hwan Director	010-4789-3282
Incheon / Bucheon · Siheung · Ansan	
Oh Gun-hoon Director	010-3495-6515
Songpa · Gangdong · Jamsil / Japanese liquor	
Shin Hong-cheol Director	010-9259-6474
Bundang · Pangyo · Gwanggyo / Suwon · Yongin · Anyang	
Bae Jong-hwan GM	010-9209-6526
Gangseo · Yangcheon · Guro · Geumcheon · Yeongdeungpo / Goyang · Paju · Gimpo	
Yu Kwang-seok GM	010-4565-6039
Hanam · Misa · Guri · Namyangju · Uijeongbu	
Sung Hyun-woo GM	010-3375-3646
Yongsan · Itaewon · Hannam / Mapo · Seodaemun · Eunpyeong	
Hwang Hyun-woong Dep. GM	010-9123-4341
New account development	

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